

Government of India
Ministry of Commerce and Industry
Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade

STATES' STARTUP RANKING FRAMEWORK

6th Edition

DPIIT #startupindia

August 2025

1. Vision

- Following the launch of the Startup India initiative by Hon'ble Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi to catalyze the growth of India's startup ecosystem, the first States' Startup Conference was convened in July 2016. The aim was to encourage States and Union Territories to foster their local startup ecosystems through targeted policy interventions, institutional frameworks, effective monitoring and recognition mechanisms.
- Since then, this periodic capacity-building and ranking exercise has become a cornerstone for energising the startup economy across the nation. It plays a crucial role in aligning key stakeholders, encouraging innovation-driven development and fostering healthy competition among States and UTs — collectively propelling India towards greater self-reliance and sustainable economic growth.
- The Ranking Exercise is employing a systematic approach towards recognizing States and Union Territories with mature and nascent Startup Ecosystems.
- The exercise will provide impetus to all enablers within States and Union Territories to maintain a conducive environment for the startup ecosystem.
- The objective is to establish an institutional framework that fosters collaboration between the Government, Private Sector, and Academia to collectively strengthen and scale the startup ecosystem across the country.

2. General Principles

- The framework would evaluate progress made from 1st January 2025 to 31st May 2026 (The period of consideration for the 5th edition framework was from January 2023 to December 2024). Consequently, submission of documentary evidence by states and union territories through the States' Startup Ranking Portal will need to be submitted by 10th May 2026.
- For the purposes of evaluation, all States and UTs have been divided into two categories: Category A and Category B. Category A has been further divided into two sub-categories, namely A1 and A2.
- The scores of various aspects in the framework may be divided into the following categories:
 - a) Document Submission
 - b) Private Ecosystem Assessment
 - c) Feedback Survey Scoring

3. Summary

Overview of Reform Areas, Action Points, and Score Allocation (Total Score: 75, Action Points: 19):

Reform Area	Action Point	Marks	Total Score
1. Institutional Support	1. Support Provided to Startups by State/UT Department(s)	6	18
	2. For development with a progressive and innovative focus	5	
	3. Facilitation of grassroot innovation and support to women & young entrepreneurs	7	
2. Infrastructure Support	4. Incubation and Acceleration support	7	16
	5. Infrastructure support in Tier 2, Tier 3 and Tier 4 regions	4	
	6. Access to Digital Infrastructure	5	
3. Funding Opportunities	7. Ease of access to funding	3	11
	8. Funding through state supported funds or mechanisms	4	
	9. Support in fundraising initiatives	4	
4. Market Access & Reach	10. Market access opportunity provided to startups through Public Procurement	5	11
	11. Access to Domestic and International Market Opportunities and Partnerships	4	
	12. Facilitating Ease of Doing Business for Startups through Trusted Partner & Green Channel	2	
5. Ecosystem Capacity Building	13. Capacity Building of State/UT Government Departments on Startup Ecosystem	3	8
	14. State/UT supported initiatives to sensitize ecosystem enablers	5	
6. Focus on Innovation & Sustainability	15. Initiatives undertaken by the State/UT to facilitate research and innovation	4	9
	16. Support for Startups in Green Growth and Sustainability	2	
	17. Entrepreneurial growth in the social innovation landscape	3	
7. Impact and Recognition	18. Job opportunities created by startups	1	2
	19. Recognition of the startup ecosystem	1	

4. Scoring Details

- a) Document Submission - Scores will be awarded based on documentary evidence submitted by States and UTs in compliance with reform areas and action points as per 6th edition.
- b) Private Ecosystem Assessment - Scores will be rewarded based on private ecosystem mapping (10% of total score).
- c) Feedback Survey Scoring - Scores will be awarded based on survey responses (15% of total score).

Ranking Framework Overview

S.No	Reform Area	Score	Action Points	Absolute Scoring	Relative Scoring
1	Institutional Support	18	3	3	0
2	Infrastructure Support	16	3	2	1
3	Funding Opportunities	11	3	3	0
4	Market Access & Reach	11	3	2	1
5	Ecosystem Capacity Building	8	2	1	1
6	Focus on Innovation & Sustainability	9	3	3	0
7	Impact & Recognition	2	2	2	0
Total		75	19	16	3

Feedback Mechanism & Private Ecosystem Mapping

Tentative Feedback Questionnaire:

1. Mentorship support provided within State/UT
2. Accelerator or incubator programs available
3. Synergy between academia and industry
4. Sectoral policies dedicated to Startups
5. Startup focus on identified priority sectors
6. Female founder support & special incentives
7. Grievance portal or helpline resolution
8. Funding support received
9. Opportunities to showcase products/services
10. Deep tech, renewable energy & sustainability focus
11. Pitching sessions / demo days / workshops
12. Events to connect with ecosystem stakeholders

Private Ecosystem Mapping:

Assessment covers key dimensions: private capital access, startup infrastructure, industry initiatives, corporate innovation, global linkages, diversity & inclusion.

Categorization of States and Union Territories (UTs)

Category A1 (>5 Crore population):

1. Bihar, 2. Gujarat, 3. Karnataka, 4. Madhya Pradesh, 5. Maharashtra, 6. Rajasthan, 7. Tamil Nadu, 8. Uttar Pradesh, 9. West Bengal

Category A2 (1-5 Crore population):

1. Andhra Pradesh, 2. Chhattisgarh, 3. Haryana, 4. Jammu & Kashmir, 5. Jharkhand, 6. Kerala, 7. NCT of Delhi, 8. Odisha, 9. Punjab, 10. Telangana, 11. Uttarakhand

Category B States & Rationale

Category B (<1 Crore population):

1. Andaman & Nicobar Islands, 2. Arunachal Pradesh, 3. Assam, 4. Chandigarh, 5. Dadra & Nagar Haveli and Daman & Diu, 6. Goa, 7. Himachal Pradesh, 8. Ladakh, 9. Lakshadweep, 10. Manipur, 11. Meghalaya, 12. Mizoram, 13. Nagaland, 14. Puducherry, 15. Sikkim, 16. Tripura

Rationale:

Population metric based on Census 2011 data ensures fair benchmarking across diverse geographies.

Reform Area 1: Institutional Support

1. Support Provided to Startups by State/UT Department(s)

Questions:

1.1 Active Startup Policy

1.2 Policy amendments / renewals

1.3 Nodal team structure & hierarchy

1.4 Budget allocated for FY 2024-25 & 2025-26

1.5 Support by other non-nodal departments

Max Score: 6 Marks (Document Weightage: 100%)

AP 1 Guidelines: Institutional Support

Mandatory Guidelines (1-14):

- Details of State Startup Policy, amendments, Nodal Officer.
- Budget allocation from official government documents for FY 2024-25 & 2025-26.
- Beneficiary list of startups mandatory.

Recommended Guidelines (1-8):

- Context on proposed budget usage and year-on-year increases.

2. For Development with Progressive & Innovative Focus

Questions:

2.1 Priority Sectors identified in State/UT

2.2 Initiatives launched & startups supported in Priority Sectors

2.3 Deep Tech and AI-focused initiatives

Max Score: 5 Marks (Document Weightage: 100%)

AP 2 Guidelines: Priority Sectors & Deep Tech

Mandatory Guidelines (1-14):

- **Official GO/Notification identifying priority sectors.**
- **Specific focus on Deep Tech, AI, Robotics, IoT, Blockchain, Quantum.**

Recommended Guidelines (1-6):

- **Sectoral strengths in Agriculture, Semiconductor, CleanTech, FinTech.**

3. Facilitation of Grassroot Innovation & Support to Women

Questions:

3.1 Tier 2, Tier 3, Tier 4 district startups supported

3.2 Initiatives in Aspirational Districts

3.3 Women-led startups & dedicated initiatives

3.4 Awareness programs in schools & colleges

Max Score: 7 Marks (Document Weightage: 100%)

AP 3 Supporting Documents & Guidelines

Supporting Documents:

- Categorization proof of Tier 2/3/4 districts & aspirational districts.
- List of unique women-led startups registered on Bharat Startup Ecosystem Registry.
- School & college program attendance sheets & reports.

AP 3 Recommended Guidelines

Recommended Guidelines (1-19):

- Breakdown of supported startups by district.
- Special incentives offered to women-led startups (seed funding, venture funding, incubation, marketing assistance).
- Student outreach numbers & follow-up support.

Reform Area 2: Infrastructure Support

4. Incubation and Acceleration Support

Questions:

- 4.1 Manufacturing & non-manufacturing incubators established/upgraded
- 4.2 Incubators/accelerators supported via capacity development
- 4.3 Deep Tech capabilities within incubation centers
- 4.4 Incubator capacity building in Tier 2/3/4 cities

Max Score: 7 Marks (Document Weightage: 100%)

AP 4 Supporting Documents & Guidelines

Mandatory Guidelines (1-8):

- Unique list of State-supported incubators.
- Details of specific support provided (workspace, labs, testing zones).
- Acceleration program cohort details and mentorship proof.

5. Infrastructure Support in Tier 2, Tier 3, Tier 4 Regions

Questions:

5.1 Dedicated infrastructure initiatives in Tier 2/3/4 regions

5.2 Percentage of districts covered

Max Score: 4 Marks (Document Weightage: 100%)

Mandatory Guidelines 1-7, Recommended Guidelines 1-2.

6. Access to Digital Infrastructure

Questions:

6.1 Stakeholders registered on State Startup Portal

6.2 Digital features (online incentives, grievance redressal, local language, PwD accessibility, internal dashboard)

6.3 Promotion of BHASKAR & DPIIT recognition

Max Score: 5 Marks

Reform Area 3: Funding Opportunities

7. Ease of Access to Funding

Questions:

7.1 Funding mechanisms (Seed Fund, Venture Fund, Fund of Funds, special banking provisions)

Max Score: 3 Marks (Document Weightage: 100%)

Mandatory Guidelines 1-9, Recommended 1-4.

8. Funding Through State Supported Funds or Mechanisms

Questions:

8.1 Startups receiving funding / grants

8.2 Percentage of funds disbursed & average disbursement timeline

Max Score: 4 Marks

AP 8 Guidelines: Fund Disbursal

Mandatory Guidelines (1-15):

- Minimum funding amount: ₹5 Lakh (Category A), ₹2 Lakh (Category B).
- Average disbursement calculation: $\text{Date of actual disbursal} - \text{Date of formal application}$.
- Non-duplicity of startups ensured.

9. Support in Fundraising Initiatives

Questions:

9.1 Pitching sessions & investor engagement events

9.2 Successful investor-startup connections facilitated

Max Score: 4 Marks

AP 9 Guidelines: Investor Connection

Mandatory Guidelines (1-10):

- Platform to connect Investors / Angel Networks with Startups.
- Proof of due diligence stage reached for successful connects.
- State nodal team active facilitation evidence.

Reform Area 4: Market Access & Reach

10. Public Procurement Market Access Opportunity

Questions:

10.1 Tenders/RFPs with startup relaxations

10.2 Work orders awarded in Aspirational Districts

10.3 Market access opportunities in priority sectors

Max Score: 5 Marks

AP 10 Guidelines: Public Procurement

Mandatory Guidelines (1-16):

- Official GO or notification outlining procurement exemptions.
- Minimum order value: \$1,00,000 per Startup.
- GeM portal work orders considered with valid contract proof.

11. Domestic & International Market Linkages

Questions:

11.1 Domestic partnerships & PPP market linkages

11.2 International stakeholder partnerships (MoU, pitching, showcases)

Max Score: 4 Marks

AP 11 Guidelines: Domestic & International Market Access

Mandatory Guidelines (1-16):

- **Formally signed active agreements (PPP/MoU/Contracts).**
- **Minimum 2 forms of evidence required.**
- **Global partners: foreign governments, global VCs, trade bodies, multilateral agencies.**

12. Ease of Doing Business & Green Channel Mechanisms

Questions:

12.1 Trusted Partner / Green Channel fast-track approvals

12.2 Average processing time comparison vs standard entities

Max Score: 2 Marks

AP 12 Guidelines: Green Channel

Recommended Guidelines (1-10):

- Data on average reduction in processing timeline.
- Coverage across trade license, pollution NOC, factory license, building plan approval.

Reform Area 5: Ecosystem Capacity Building

13. Capacity Building of Government Departments

Questions:

13.1 Sensitization workshops for Startup Nodal Agency & departments

13.2 Tier 2/3/4 district capacity building

13.3 Government officials trained count

Max Score: 3 Marks

AP 13 Recommended Guidelines

Recommended Guidelines:

- **Topics:** Startup India benefits, National/Global best practices, IPR, sector solutions.
- **Geo-tagged photos & collaboration with national institutes (LBSNAA, ATI, IIPA).**

14. Initiatives to Sensitize Ecosystem Enablers

Questions:

14.1 Sensitization initiatives for startups

14.2 Active mentors count

14.3 Capacity programs for mentors & investors

14.4 Participation in Startup India State Ranking Workshops

Max Score: 5 Marks

AP 14 Guidelines: Sensitizing Enablers

Mandatory Guidelines (1-7):

- **Official list of active mentors with signed engagement documents.**
- **Avoid double counting mentors.**
- **Evidence of participation in Startup India State Ranking Workshops.**

Reform Area 6: Focus on Innovation & Sustainability

15. Facilitate Research and Innovation

Questions:

15.1 IPR fast-tracking provisions (patents, trademarks, copyrights)

15.2 R&D grants, infrastructure, and partnerships

15.3 Active educational / research institutions engaged in R&D

Max Score: 4 Marks

16. Support for Green Growth and Sustainability

Questions:

16.1 Startups supported in renewable energy, clean tech, sustainability

16.2 Districts with green startups present

Max Score: 2 Marks

AP 16 Guidelines: Green Growth & Circular Economy

Recommended Guidelines (1-4):

- Impact metrics: carbon savings, waste reduction, renewable energy adoption.
- State-level green innovation challenges and circular economy models.

17. Entrepreneurial Growth in Social Innovation

Questions:

17.1 Initiatives supporting Social Enterprise startups

17.2 Social startups supported & district coverage

Max Score: 3 Marks

Mandatory definition of Social Enterprise published in public domain.

Reform Area 7: Impact and Recognition

18. Job Opportunities Created by Startups

Questions:

18.1 Dedicated platform/portal for startup jobs, internships, apprenticeships

Max Score: 1 Mark

Supporting Documents: ESI scheme registration numbers, direct job creation proof, self-declared startup reports.

19. Recognition of the Startup Ecosystem

Questions:

19.1 Startups receiving accolades / awards in national & international forums

Max Score: 1 Mark

Supporting Documents: Official award scheme documents, press releases, media coverage, founder spotlights.

Details & Abbreviations

Abbreviations:

1. DPIIT: Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade
2. SISFS: Startup India Seed Fund Scheme
3. FoFs: Fund of Funds
4. CGSS: Credit Guarantee Scheme for Startups
5. MAARG: Mentorship, Advisory, Assistance, Resilience, and Growth
6. BHASKAR: Bharat Startup Knowledge Access Registry
7. MoU: Memorandum of Understanding
8. GeM: Government e Marketplace
9. Soonicorn: Startup rapidly growing towards \$1B valuation
10. Unicorn: Startup valued at \$1B or more
11. GO: Government Order
12. API: Application Programming Interface
13. CXO: Chief Officer positions
14. Cloud Infrastructure: Web-based platform for cloud resources
15. NEFT/RTGS: Electronic funds transfer systems
16. RFP: Request for Proposal
17. EMD: Earnest Money Deposit
18. Hackathon: Software collaboration event
19. HEIs: Higher Educational Institutions
20. ESG: Environmental, Social, and Governance
21. EPC: Engineering, Procurement, and Construction
22. PPP: Public Private Partnership